

WE BELIEVE IN ONE GOD, THE ONENESS OF GOD, GOD IS ONE AND HAS NO PARTNERS

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Servants Lessons

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THE ORTHODOX CREED

- We believe in One God and that He has no equal.
- Our belief is Monotheistic, unlike the pagans who believe in many gods.
- The Bible in both its testaments confirms that God is one.
- (Matthew 19:17).
- (1 Corinthians 8:4).
- (Deuteronomy 6:4).
- (Isaiah 45:4).
- (Isaiah 45:21).

THE HOLY TRINITY

INTRODUCTION

- The doctrine and belief in the Holy Trinity is a cornerstone of Christianity. This belief is that there is one God, one ousia or essence, and three hypostases or Persons Who are distinct but not separate. This formula is part of what distinguishes Christians from non-Christians.
- **Definition:** Whenever speaking about theology, one must not only be very accurate and particular as to which words to use, one must also make sure that the right definitions to those words are understood in order to make sure that everyone is speaking with the same understanding.

THE HOLY TRINITY

- ANALOGIES: When trying to understand Who God is, we can only go so far as to what God reveals to us since this is what our limited mind will comprehend when trying to understand the unlimited God. You may have heard of the story of one who was walking along the beach and he saw a child taking water from the sea and trying to put it in a hole in the sand. This man thought that what the child was doing was silly, but then was rebuked himself of trying to understand the unlimited God by our limited mind. However, the fathers of the Church have given us analogies to help us both understand the doctrine of the Holy Trinity and explain it to others.

THE HOLY TRINITY IN THE HOLY SCRIPTURES

- Although there is no explicit reference to the term “Holy Trinity”, yet there are several passages in the Holy Bible that mention the Holy Trinity: the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, One God.
- From the very beginning of the Holy Scriptures, the first verses in the book of Genesis expose us to this when it
- is written: “In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth. The earth was without form, and void; and darkness was on the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God was hovering over the face of the waters. Then God said,...” (Gen. 1:1-3).

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- So here we are immediately exposed to God the Father, the Holy Spirit Who was hovering over the face of the waters and the Son, the Word of God, Who says. Moreover, in the Hebrew, God is written as Elohim, or the plural of God, referring in the same context, to the Holy Trinity, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Spirit.
- (Deuteronomy 6:4)
- (Genesis 1:26- 27)
- (Genesis 3:22- 24)
- (Genesis 11:6-7)
- (Isiah 48:16)
- (Isiah 61:1)

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- (Matthew 28:19)
- (Matt. 3:16-17)
- (Mark 1:10-11)
- (Luke 3:21-22)
- (2 Cor. 13:14)
- (Rom. 8:1-4)
- (1 Cor. 12:3-7)
- (Gal. 4:4-6)
- (Eph. 1:3-14, 2:18; 4:4-6)
- (2Thess. 2:13-14)
- (Tit. 3:4-6)
- (Heb. 9:14)
- (1 Pet. 1:2)

DIVINE TITLES AND ATTRIBUTES REFERRING TO ALL THREE HYPOSTASES

- There are certain attributes and titles that the Holy Bible uses in respect to God Himself. Furthermore, these words are used in reference to each of the three hypostases of the Holy Trinity to show that they are not only God, but are one and the same essence since they have been described by each of these words. We will only mention some of these attributes.
- Love – Father (Rom. 5:5, 8; 8:39; 2Cor. 13:11, 14; Eph. 2:4; 6:23; 2Thess. 3:5; 1Jn. 4:7-8), Son (Rom. 5:8; 8:35, 39; 2Cor. 5:14; Eph. 2:5; 3:19; 5:2, 25; 6:23; 1Tim. 1:14; 2Tim. 1:13; Tit. 3:4), Holy Spirit (Rom. 5:5; 15:30; Gal. 5:22; Col. 1:8).
- Truth – Father (Jer. 10:10; Rom. 1:25; 3:7; 15:8), Son (Jn 14:6; 2Cor. 11:10; Eph. 4:21; Rev. 3:7), Holy Spirit (1Jn. 5:6; Jn. 14:17; 15:26; 16; 13).

DIVINE TITLES AND ATTRIBUTES REFERRING TO ALL THREE HYPOSTASES

- Eternal – Father (Rom. 1:20; Tit. 1:2), Son (1Tim. 1:17), Holy Spirit (Heb. 9:14).
- Life-giving – Father (Rom. 4:17; 6:4, 22-23; 1Tim. 6:13; Tit. 1:2), Son (Jn 5:21; Rom. 5:17, 21; 6:4, 22-23; 1Cor. 15:45; 2Cor. 4:10-11; 2Tim. 1:1, 10), Holy Spirit (Jn 6:63; Rom. 8:2, 10-11; 2Cor. 3:6; Gal. 6:8). Ps. 33:6 is for the Holy Trinity: “By the word of the LORD the heavens were made, and all the host of them by the breath of His mouth”.
- Holy – In the book of Isaiah alone, the phrase “the Holy One of Israel” appears 25 times referring to God. The same phrase is mentioned in Ps. 71:22; 78:41; 89:18; Jer. 50:29; 51:5; Ez. 39:7.

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- Furthermore, the Trisagion, i.e. “Holy, Holy, Holy” is mentioned in Isaiah 6:3 as well as the book of Revelation 4:8 to Him Who is sitting on the throne. St. John tells us in his Gospel that this praise in the book of Isaiah was directed towards the Son when he writes: “These things Isaiah said when he saw His glory and spoke of Him” (Jn. 12:41). The other times this title is mentioned in the book of Revelation (3:7; 6:10; 15:4), they are all in reference to the Son.

DIVINE TITLES AND ATTRIBUTES REFERRING TO ALL THREE HYPOSTASES

- There are also many verses in the Holy Bible that mention the Holy Spirit (e.g. Ps. 51:11; Matt. 1:18; Mk. 1:8; Lk. 1:41; Jn. 14:26; Rom. 5:5; 9:1; 14:17; 15:13, 16; 1Cor. 2:13; 6:19; 7:34; 12:3; 2Cor. 6:6; 13:14; Eph. 1:13; 3:5; 4:30; 1Thess. 1:5-6; 4:8; 2Tim. 1:14; Tit. 3:5; Heb. 2:4; 3:7; 6:4; 9:8; 10:15; besides many others). Since the Holy Spirit is also the Spirit of God (Rom. 8:9, 14; 15:19; 1Cor. 2:11, 14; 3:16; 7:40; 12:3; Eph. 4:30) and the Spirit of Christ (Rom. 8:9), then one can infer from these verses that St. Paul is also saying that the Father and Son are Holy.



Glory be to the Holy Trinity

The Father, The Son, and The
Holy Spirit ONE GOD

Amen!